forgotten in Pakistan. Second, and just as importantly, ‘freedom wasn’t from the “conniving Hindus” as is popularly believed but from the British, whom the forefathers of many people in the current Pakistani elite admired and served’. The result is that today ‘[i]n Pakistan, rarely is the British rule questioned and explained’ and ‘[m]ost Pakistani history books focus on the suffering of Muslims as a minority before partition’. Thus, they inevitably ‘highlight the difference between Islam and Hinduism as religions to reinforce the theory that the two communities could not have lived together’. Such is the combined perversion of the two falsities that today, ‘Pakistan’s narrative does not define the British as colonisers and exploiters who created the civil service, infrastructure, education system and other institutions for its administration’, but that ‘[i]nstead, the narrative defines Hindus as exploiters’ to the extent that ‘[s]ome people in Pakistan are still in awe of the British and voice the idea that had they stayed in India longer, the country would have been even more developed and peaceful’.

There is, however, a third reason why Bhagat Singh could be important for setting the record straight in Pakistan. This is a country in search of suitable icons. One such was ‘Zulfikar Ali Bhutto . . . often credited with democratising and empowering Pakistan’s poor in the 1970s’, and though his life was brutally cut short, ‘[f]rom his descendants to current Pakistani political leaders such as Imran Khan and Shahbaz Sharif—all have tried to copy Bhutto’s public persona and political intrigues’ because the fact was that ‘Bhutto was a progressive, socialist and a liberal’. Yet, largely because of his folly in trying ‘to appease his right-wing opponents’ by defining ‘what a Muslim is in Pakistan’s 1973 Constitution’ and ‘thus, declaring Ahmedis legally non-Muslim’, his name has been tarnished and ‘[h]ence, his legacy is forever tainted and controversial’. Consequently, for the Lahore-based writer and journalist Ammara Ahmad, ‘[t]his makes somebody of the stature of Bhagat Singh an even more important historical figure for Pakistan’, not least because ‘[m]ore than half of Pakistani population is ethnically Punjabi, as is the political elite . . .’. This is because what is distinctive about Bhagat Singh is that ‘[l]ike Bhutto, he was also a socialist, with a soft corner for the poor’, and this can have a huge